

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Lead building FinOS end-to-end.*

Positioning, 13 years owning product in regulated, complex domains, now focused on the single platform that replaces fragmented SME finance.

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§ WHY FINANSHEL

Finanshels is doing something specific: replacing a collection of manual, disconnected workflows with one coherent operating system for a customer segment that has historically been underserved by software. The framing in the job description, "talented builders shipping AI-powered solutions against individual pieces, without a unifying product view", describes a real structural problem, and fixing it is squarely the kind of work I have done before. At EMIL Group I walked into a fragmented 18-person delivery organisation, restructured it into three focused teams, and shipped the Claims Center from scratch. The challenge here is larger, the domain is fintech, and the stakes are higher. *That is the kind of problem worth relocating to Dubai for.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo refactors and spec generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, assisted development across projects
- **Cursor/VSCode**, editor-native AI coding
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Framer**, design-heavy wireframes and flows
- **GPT**, research, drafting, edge-case generation
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation
- **Gamma.app**, strategy documents and stakeholder decks

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Docker, GitOps rollout and rollback, Jenkins, CI/CD pipelines, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Kafka, Azure DevOps, GitLab, all in production contexts across defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance, and fintech.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Zero-to-one B2B marketplace matching construction firms with workers, built and operated solo.

- Anonymity-until-payment model that protects both sides until commitment, delivered over WhatsApp and Telegram.
 - LLM agents across the funnel so one person runs day-to-day operations without a back-office team.
 - Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL to measure drop-off and iterate the flow.
 - Directly relevant: it is a regulated, two-sided platform with a complex multi-step customer journey rebuilt as a productised flow.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT FINANSHELS

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the accounting, tax, and CX workflows end to end, map every handoff that currently lives in email or a spreadsheet, and identify where customer effort is highest.

WEEK 2

Diagnose and sequence.

Turn the map into a prioritised list of friction points, score each by customer hours lost and operational cost, and draft the first version of what gets built and in what order.

WEEK 3+

Ship, measure, close loops.

Instrument the first automated flow with the data team, hold the roadmap accountable to the metrics from day one, and establish the product rituals, problem definition, success criteria, evaluation, that the team uses from here on.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Finanshels team,

I am applying for the Product Lead role. My background is 13 years of product ownership in regulated, operationally complex environments, insurance, public-sector analytics, defence AI, and fintech. I have spent most of that time in exactly the situation you describe: a product that exists as a collection of manual steps and disconnected systems, and a mandate to replace it with something coherent.

At EMIL Group I joined an 18-person delivery organisation that had lost the confidence of its senior engineers and its clients. I restructured it into three focused teams, shipped the Claims Center from concept to production, and cut the time to launch a new insurance product from months to under a week. At Bundesagentur für Arbeit I introduced Dagster and dbt into a national labour-market data platform, reducing the time per quarterly data update by 75% and removing the manual hand-holding that had been blocking the team. Both of those are versions of the same problem you are hiring to fix: human effort absorbing what the product should do.

I have shipped AI-powered features in production and understand what it takes to do it responsibly, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop checkpoints, audit trails, guardrails. At Rohde & Schwarz I owned the internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme, managing 15 engineers and data scientists through Scrum. I also build with AI myself daily: Claude Code, Copilot, Cursor, and Lovable are in my regular workflow, and I use n8n for agentic automation. I co-founded Kvitt Payment Solutions, a fintech P2P payments product that was acquired by Sparkasse and operated inside the girocard ecosystem, so the financial services domain is not new to me.

The charter you are describing, mapping and rebuilding the customer journey across accounting, taxation, and bookkeeping on FinOS, establishing product standards for an AI-native team, and owning prioritisation and sequencing from the ground up, is the kind of role I have been looking for. I am based in Berlin, willing to relocate to Dubai, and available at short notice.

I would be glad to walk through a concrete before-and-after journey map in a conversation.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ PROFILE

Product manager and product owner with 13 years of product ownership in regulated industries, fintech, insurance, healthcare, defence AI, and public-sector analytics. I map and rebuild complex customer journeys, turn strategy and user needs into a prioritised roadmap, and lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery. I have shipped AI-powered products to production and introduced product discipline where none previously existed.

§ HOW I WORK

- I leave my ego at home. I want to drive the decision, not to have the last word.
 - On a new product I spend a little to learn before spending a lot to build. Cheap experiments make expensive decisions safe(r).
 - Outcome over output. Producing something is not the achievement; it also has to fit a market, so I agree what would count as success before we build and check afterwards whether it happened.
 - I keep the whole value chain in view, not just the backlog. Defect-to-fix time is a product metric; architects and DevOps engineers build that chain, my job is to steer it into the right lanes.
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§ WORK EXPERIENCE

PRODUCT MANAGER, ROHDE & SCHWARZ, MUNICH / REMOTE | 07/2024 - 05/2025

Defence and aerospace. Internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme.

- Championed GitOps delivery and test automation with ArgoCD, reducing rollout time from days to 30 minutes across multinational teams.
- Redirected product strategy based on user workflow analysis, increasing pipeline runs by 200% by prioritising developer-code-first over UI-led design.
- Led a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence.

PRODUCT MANAGER, BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT (FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY), NUREMBERG / REMOTE | 05/2023 - 07/2024

Public sector. National labour-market analytics platform for policymakers and researchers. Deputy IT Security Officer.

- Introduced Dagster and dbt so quarterly data imports ran without hand-holding, saving almost 75% of the time per data update.
- Migrated a bare-metal system fully into containers and carried a full UI relaunch and a large ETL migration through the same period.

PRODUCT OWNER, CLINET PLATFORMS, BERLIN | 01/2023 - 07/2023

Healthcare. Mobile patient app for iOS and Android, piloted in hospitals.

- Cut the roadmap to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures: user acceptance rose more than fivefold.
- Integrated the CGM interface into hospital information system workflows, reducing digital anamnesis time from 30 minutes to 5.

PRODUCT MANAGER, EMIL GROUP, BERLIN | 04/2022 - 12/2022

Insurance. B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers, brokers and underwriters.

- Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams: attrition fell from near-total exodus to a single departure.
- Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production with no precedent, and cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to under a week.

PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION TEAM, SCHEIDT & BACHMANN FUEL & CONVENIENCE RETAIL, MÖNCHENGLADBACH | 09/2021 - 03/2022

- Retail and payments, POS and forecourt systems. Moved research results into production in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM), BUNDESDRUCKEREI, BERLIN | 03/2021 - 06/2021

- Government, secure data platform. Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY), AOK ITSCARE, FRANKFURT | 03/2019 - 05/2020

- Health insurance, B2B procurement webshop. Migrated a legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; still in production.

PROJECT LEAD, ENERCON, WISMAR / MAGDEBURG | 04/2019 - 12/2019

- Wind energy, full site IT modernisation end to end.

PRODUCT OWNER, WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN, ISNY | 08/2017 - 06/2018

- Healthcare, clinical network. Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.
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§ FOUNDER TRACK

FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER, CONSTRUCT8, LIMASSOL | 12/2025 - 06/2026

- Construction staffing, two-sided B2B marketplace. Zero to one alone: anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp and Telegram as product surface, LLM agents across the funnel.

CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER, QCRYPT AG, BERLIN | 01/2016 - 12/2021

- IT security, quantum-secure encryption. Shipped a three-layer product that installs in under two minutes for enterprise buyers. Later Chair of the board.

CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO, SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES, BERLIN | 03/2018 - 08/2021

- Nanotechnology and agriculture. Took a fertiliser product from laboratory to investor rounds, owning financial planning and investor reporting.

FOUNDER AND CFO, KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS, BERLIN | 02/2013 - 11/2018

- Fintech, mobile group-based P2P payments. Built from zero and taken to acquisition: acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.
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§ SKILLS

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, epics, backlog refinement, sprint planning, retrospectives, story-point estimation, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, Prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, go-to-market support.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, and Lovable.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Agile, Scrum, Kanban, WIP limits, SAgile (Scaled Agile Framework), ART, PI planning.

Analytics and data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, ETL (extract, transform, load), Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

Technical Environments Owned: Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Docker, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Azure DevOps.

Governance and Business: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership, ROI reasoning.

Fintech and regulated domains: P2P payments product (Kvitt, acquired by Sparkasse), girocard ecosystem, insurance platform (EMIL), public-sector data, healthcare.

§ EDUCATION

DIPLOM-WIRTSCHAFTSINGENIEUR (INDUSTRIAL ENGINEERING AND MANAGEMENT, EQUIVALENT TO A MASTER'S DEGREE), TECHNISCHE UNIVERSITÄT BERLIN (TU BERLIN), GERMANY | 10/2006 - 09/2014

- Specialisation: Logistics. Thesis with Siemens AG Energy Service on balancing-power market profitability.

§ LANGUAGES

German (native speaker, C2) · English (C2, business and technical fluency)

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